

Interview tip: Demonstrate your thought process

Previously, you considered an example of an interview where the interviewee specifically explained their thought process behind each response. In this reading, you'll review what you learned from the interview and why it will be useful for your own future interviews. You'll also explore some examples of questions that interviewers might ask so that you can practice your answers.

Talk through your answers to demonstrate your thinking

Problem-solving is a top skill hiring managers want candidates interviewing to have. During your interview, you want to demonstrate your problem-solving skills by giving interviewers insight into how you think, how you approach problems, and how you organize information.

You can do that by focusing on your process instead of the result. When you describe past projects you've completed, challenges you've overcome, or problems you've solved for your previous employers, take the time to describe how and why you did it. This will give your interviewers a better understanding of how you personally think through problems—which tells them a lot more about you as a job candidate than just a list of projects you've completed!

Build interview skills

Interviewing is a skill. And like so many of the other skills you've been learning throughout this program, you can practice and grow your interview skills! These tips are designed to help you focus on specific skills that you can apply to your own interviews in the future. Reviewing tips from other professionals who have gone through the interview process and practicing what you learned are great ways to develop those skills over time.

Practice interview skills

Now that you've gained a new tip to add to your own interview toolkit, you'll want to practice by answering questions you could encounter in an actual interview. Consider how you might apply the interview tip you focused on in this reading: sharing your thought process to showcase what you know and how you approach problem-solving. Here is a list of questions you might apply this tip to during an interview:

- Describe a time that you struggled with a data problem. What was the source of your struggle? What did you learn as a result?
- Suppose you're working for a company that wants to modernize their data lake and

data warehouse. What are some components of a modern cloud data platform they should consider?

- What steps would you take to translate a business question to an analytical solution?